

Paper 2: Listening and understanding in French

Content

Students are assessed on their understanding of standard spoken French in formal and informal contexts, and familiar and unfamiliar settings.

Students need to:

- identify and respond to key points, details and opinions
- recognise the relationship between past, present and future events
- undertake a short dictation in the target language, applying the principles by which spelling represents sounds in standard or widely used forms of French.

This paper draws on the specified vocabulary (*Appendix 1*) and grammar (*Appendix 2*) and the focus of the passages will be taken from the thematic contexts listed in the specification (see [Thematic Contexts](#)).

Recordings have been created to reflect the following authentic listening scenarios:

- newswatches, newsclips, weather forecasts, public announcements, advertisements, monologues, conversations, podcasts, extracts of talks or presentations and short reports.

Students are presented with short and medium-length recorded scenarios involving one or more speakers.

Recordings will be spoken using standard French at no faster than a moderate pace.

To avoid students confusing unfamiliar names of people with necessary vocabulary, we will only use names from the prescribed list in *Appendix 3*.

Assessment information

- First assessment is in May/June 2026.
- The assessment is out of 50 marks.

Section A: Listening Comprehension (40 marks)

All questions in this section are set in English, using the following question types: multiple choice, multiple response and short open response questions.

Students write their responses in English.